



STATE RELOCATION GUIDE · AUSTRALIA

Tasmania

Where you would work, where you would live, and what an ordinary week looks like in Tasmania.

Ethicare Resourcing

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ethicareresourcing.com

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This guide is free, and so is everything in it. Every chapter here is also on the website, where it is kept up to date — so if you are reading this some months after downloading it, check the site for anything that looks time-sensitive. Fees, tax rates and immigration settings change without much notice.

We don't print these. A PDF costs nothing to send and nothing to ship, which felt like the right answer for a company that spends its days moving people around the world.

Welcome to Tasmania

Tasmania Guide · Chapter 1 of 9

Tasmania is the deliberate choice. Nobody drifts to an island 240 kilometres off the south coast — you choose it, for the wilderness at the end of the street, the cleanest air on record, and a health system small enough to know your name. This guide is for deciding whether to choose it.

An island that trades scale for life

About 570,000 people share an island the size of Ireland, and nearly half of them live around Hobart — a working harbour city folded between the sea and kunanyi / Mount Wellington, whose summit stands snow-dusted above the office blocks fifteen minutes from town. Launceston anchors the north amid the Tamar wine country; Devonport and Burnie hold the north-west coast where the ferry docks.

The state runs a single public health service — four principal hospitals rather than a metropolis full — and that smallness cuts both ways. Careers here are broad rather than narrow, colleagues become neighbours, and the system tends to look after the people it goes to the trouble of recruiting. The trade is the smallest job market in the country, and winters that are genuinely cold in a housing stock that wasn't always built for them.

What you get back is proximity: Cradle Mountain, Wineglass Bay, the Bay of Fires and a fleet of farm gates, distilleries and cellar doors all sit within a couple of hours of wherever you live. In Tasmania the weekend is not a plan. It is a default.

Who wrote this

We're a healthcare recruitment company, so we have an interest — but this guide isn't a pitch. There's nothing in it asking you to register, no form, and no visa advice.

Tasmania is the move people romanticise most and research least. This guide takes the winter, the market size and the island logistics as seriously as the scenery — because the clinicians who thrive here knew exactly what they were choosing.

The island, in nine numbers

~570K

People on an island the size of Ireland — Australia's only island state, across Bass Strait from Melbourne.

~250K

In Greater Hobart — the harbour capital and the widest job market on the island.

~90K

In Launceston, the elegant second city at the head of the Tamar, two and a half hours north.

4

Principal public hospitals in a single statewide service — the capital, the north, and the north-west coast.

~40%

Of the island is national park and reserve, including a World Heritage wilderness a fifth the size of the state.

1,271 m

kunanyi / Mount Wellington, rising straight out of Hobart — snow on top, city at its feet, fifteen minutes apart.

Cleanest

Air on earth, measured at Cape Grim on the north-west tip — the world's baseline air-quality station.

2.5 hrs

Hobart to Launceston by road. Almost nothing on the island is more than four hours from anything else.

UTC+10

Same clock as Melbourne and Sydney, daylight saving included — island life, mainland time.

Six things you only learn once you're here

The cold lives indoors

Winter is honest — and older weatherboard homes are draughty. Ask how a house is heated before you sign anything, and budget for warm bedding in month one.

The UV doesn't match the air

Cool air, fierce sun. The UV here burns fast even when you need a jumper — sun protection is a year-round habit, not a summer one.

You'll want a car

Public transport is light. Distances are short and the drives are lovely, but plan on driving from the start — the ferry from Geelong is the easy way to bring one over.

It's a two-degrees island

Everyone knows everyone, faster than you expect. You'll have a community in a month — and a reputation just as quickly.

Winter is embraced, not endured

Tasmania leans into the dark: Dark Mofo fills June with fire, art and feasting, and the log-fire pub is a genre of its own.

The wilderness is serious

Mobile coverage drops out fast beyond the towns. Download offline maps, tell someone your plans, and treat the weather warnings as instructions.

A note on Country

Hobart stands on the Country of the muwinina people – nipaluna – and today's Tasmanian Aboriginal community, the palawa/pakana, carries one of the oldest living cultures on earth. Dual names are official and warmly used: nipaluna (Hobart), kunanyi (Mount Wellington), kanamaluka (the Tamar), takayna (the Tarkine).

Acknowledgement of Country opens meetings, and health services work in partnership with Aboriginal community-controlled organisations. Learn the names early – using them well is noticed and appreciated.

How to read this guide

Nine chapters, all of them about Tasmania specifically. Anything true of Australia generally – Medicare, visas, Ahpra registration, tax, superannuation, schools – lives once in **Moving to Australia** rather than being repeated here.

If you read nothing else, read **Why Tasmania** for the full case – and what we'd ask you to weigh, and **Where clinicians live** – because Hobart, the north and the coast are three genuinely different lives.

Why Tasmania

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The island offers what no mainland state can: wilderness at the end of the street, seasons that mean something, and work that's visible in its community. Here is what Tasmania gives a working clinician, what a week here plausibly looks like — and who we'd steer back to the mainland.

What the island gives back

Start with the working life. A single statewide service and four principal hospitals mean careers here run broad rather than narrow: you see more, carry more, and are known by name in a way the big-city systems can't manage. Smaller systems tend to look after the people they recruit — relocation help, genuine welcomes, rosters negotiated with a human — because every arrival matters. Pay follows state enterprise agreements in the national range; we quote no figures here and will always walk you through the current agreement instead.

Then the life around the work. Housing costs less than the mainland capitals. Commutes are short everywhere. And the island's real currency is proximity: the mountain fifteen minutes from the wards, the east coast two hours, the wilderness at the end of the street. The whole of Tasmania is classed as regional for skilled migration, which can open extra visa pathways and points.

15 min

Hobart's wards to the mountain road

~40%

Of the island is park and reserve

100%

Of Tasmania counts as regional for migration

A typical week

A week here can plausibly hold all of this. A shift that starts without traffic, because nowhere in Hobart is far from anywhere else. An after-work walk on kunanyi's foothill tracks, or a swim at Kingston Beach in the long summer light. Salamanca Market on Saturday morning — produce, makers and half the people you know — then a drive up the Coal River for a cellar-door lunch. Sunday on the Tasman Peninsula under sea cliffs, home by dark.

In winter the same week bends rather than breaks: snow on the mountain over breakfast, a log fire in a pub that has kept one burning for a century, and June given over to Dark Mofo's fires and feasts. People here don't wait out the seasons. They use them.

Four real seasons — autumn is the connoisseur's pick

Russell Falls — World Heritage forest, an hour from Hobart

Sophie's insight

What I love about Tasmania is how deliberately people make time for life — a walk up kunanyi, a market on Saturday, a weekend in the wilderness. And in a smaller, close-knit system, you're valued and looked after in a way the big cities can't match.

My advice: choose the island on purpose. The clinicians who come for the life it actually offers — seasons included — are among the happiest placements I have anywhere.

Sophie Careem Founder & CEO, Ethicare Resourcing

Who we'd steer back to the mainland

The market is the country's smallest

One principal referral centre, four main hospitals. A narrow sub-specialty, a very specific career ladder or a two-clinician household may simply need a bigger system.

Winter is real, and so are the houses

Cold, dark-by-five winters in a housing stock that can be draughty. If low light flattens you, take that seriously — June here is embraced, but it is still June.

Everything crosses the Strait

Goods, holidays and family visits all mean a flight or a ferry. If your people are in Sydney or overseas, every reunion is a fare — budget it, emotionally too.

It's quiet

Hobart is a small city with a superb food scene, not a metropolis. If big-city churn recharges you, Melbourne is the honest answer — and it's 75 minutes away.

Hobart's rentals are tight

A small market with strong demand: good homes go fast. Arrive with your paperwork ready, and consider the north, where the same money goes further.

Where we'd steer you instead

If you need scale — sub-specialty depth, two careers, big-system progression — start with [Victoria](#) or [New South Wales](#).

If the dream is warmth rather than wilderness, read [Queensland](#) — Tasmania's winter is the opposite promise.

If you want lifestyle-for-money in a bigger city, [South Australia](#) is the closest mainland cousin.

In our experience

Tasmania suits clinicians who want their work to be visible in a community and their weekends to look like a documentary. The bench is smaller and the flights are real — the people who settle here counted that cost and decided the island was the point.

Tasmania at a glance

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Before the practical chapters, orientation. Tasmania is compact — Ireland-sized, two and a half hours end to end — but it divides, for a newcomer's purposes, into three quite different places sharing one cool-temperate climate and a ferry line to the mainland.

The three Tasmanias

The south

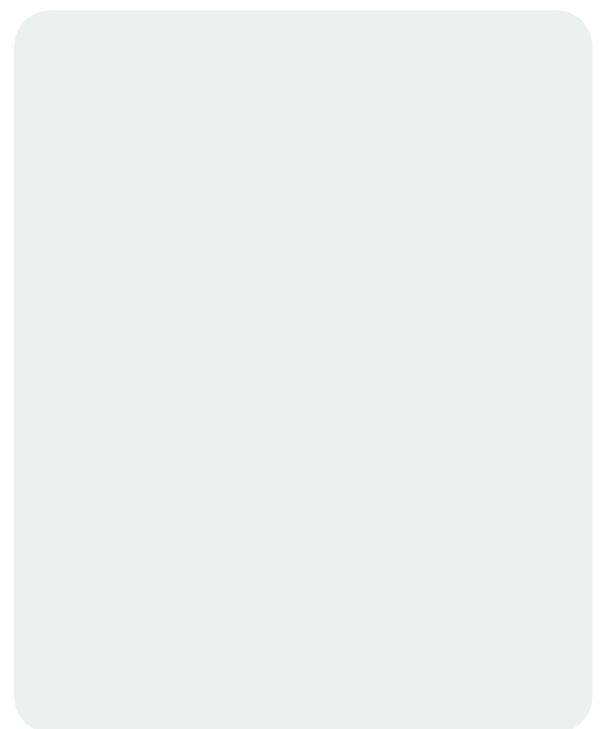
Hobart and its surrounds hold nearly half the state: the harbour city itself, the beach suburbs of Kingston and Blackmans Bay, and the Huon Valley's orchards and forests half an hour out. This is where the principal referral hospital, the widest job market and most of the island's cultural life sit — MONA, Salamanca, the festival calendar. If you take a southern post, the mountain and the Tasman Peninsula's sea cliffs are your local geography.

The north

Launceston is the elegant second city — heritage streets, the Cataract Gorge running wild through the middle of town, and the kanamaluka / Tamar Valley's vineyards all around. It carries the north's major teaching hospital, noticeably gentler housing costs, and a quietly strong food-and-wine scene. The east coast — Freycinet, the Bay of Fires — is its weekend playground.

The north-west and west

Devonport, where the Spirit of Tasmania docks, and Burnie, the working port with the coast's referral hospital, anchor a string of friendly towns along Bass Strait. Behind them the island turns wild: Cradle



Where Hobart sits, with the straight-line distance to Launceston and Devonport

Mountain ninety minutes inland, and beyond it takayna / the Tarkine, one of the largest temperate rainforests on earth. Health care out here runs on breadth, community and weather-watching.

A year in the weather

Cool temperate, with four real seasons — closer to England or the South Island of New Zealand than to mainland Australia. Summers are mild and long-lit, with evenings that stay cool; winters are cold, crisp and often blue-skied, with snow settling on kunanyi and the highlands. The weather changes fast in any month: layers and a good jacket are year-round equipment, and the UV is fierce despite the cool air.

Summer Dec – Feb 17–23° Mild · light till late
Autumn Mar – May 12–18° Still, gold, clear
Winter Jun – Aug 4–12° Cold · snow on the tops
Spring Sep – Nov 11–17° Fresh, blustery, green

Two practical notes, both about winter. Ask how any home is heated before you sign — a heat pump and decent curtains change the season entirely. And if you'll drive the mountain or highland roads, learn the black-ice habits early; locals will teach you cheerfully.

Getting on and off the island

Two clocks matter here: Tasmania runs on the same time as Melbourne and Sydney (AEST, daylight saving included), and Melbourne itself is about 75 minutes' flight from either Hobart or Launceston, with direct flights on to Sydney, Brisbane and beyond. The Spirit of Tasmania sails overnight between Devonport and Geelong — the practical way to bring a car and your belongings across Bass Strait, and many families' preferred way to arrive.

On the island itself, the road network does the work: Hobart to Launceston is two and a half hours, the east coast about two from either city, and Cradle Mountain ninety minutes from the north-west towns.

Getting around has the detail.

Words you'll hear in week one

nipalunaHobart, in palawa kani — dual naming is official and widely used

kunanyiMount Wellington — “the mountain”, and the city’s weather forecast in one glance

takaynaThe Tarkine — the vast temperate rainforest of the north-west

The SpiritThe Spirit of Tasmania ferry — how cars, furniture and grandparents cross Bass Strait

The mainlandEverywhere else in Australia. Said with affection, mostly

SalamancaHobart’s sandstone waterfront row — and the Saturday market that fills it

The shackThe Tasmanian holiday house — modest, beloved, usually by water

Scallop pieThe island’s signature bakery order — curried, contested, compulsory once

Healthcare in Tasmania

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Registration is national; hiring here is statewide. Tasmania is the one Australian state without a maze of health networks — it runs a single public service — and that shapes careers on the island more than any other fact. This chapter explains how, without naming employers, because our job is to be useful before it is promotional.

How the island system is organised

The public system runs as one statewide service under the health department: four principal hospitals — the state referral centre in the capital, a major teaching hospital in the north, and a regional referral centre on the north-west coast working alongside a nearby community hospital — plus district hospitals, community health sites and a state ambulance service. Alongside it sit private and not-for-profit hospitals, mainly in Hobart and Launceston, and Aboriginal community-controlled organisations.

One service, one state

A single statewide employer for the public system — moving between the south, north and north-west is an internal move, not a new health network.

The capital carries the depth

The principal referral hospital holds the state's specialist services — including cardiothoracic surgery, neurosurgery and burns — and the widest range of roles.

The north stands on its own

A genuine teaching hospital serves Launceston and the north-east — a full career base, not a satellite.

One national register

Ahpra registration works everywhere in Australia. The process, English evidence and assessment pathways live once in [Eligibility & registration](#).

What a small system means for a career

Breadth, mostly. With four principal hospitals covering everything from tertiary referral to district care, clinicians here see a wider case mix and carry more responsibility earlier than big-city equivalents — generalist skills are prized, and the far-flung sites run on them. The flipside is honest: some narrow sub-

specialties are referred to Melbourne, and a very specific career ladder may need a bigger system. [Why Tasmania](#) weighs that trade properly.

The social texture matters too. In a system this size you are known — by name, quickly — and the service tends to look after the people it goes to the trouble of recruiting from overseas: relocation support is common, and rural and coastal posts frequently carry incentives. It is also worth saying plainly: the whole of Tasmania is classed as regional for skilled migration, which can open extra visa pathways and points. The detail lives in [Visas & the move](#).

FOUR PRINCIPAL HOSPITALS, ONE EMPLOYER

Tasmania is the one Australian state without a maze of health networks. That single fact is why a career here can cross the island without ever crossing an employer.

The capital

The state referral centre, holding the specialist services – cardiothoracic surgery, neurosurgery and burns among them – and the widest range of roles on the island, with the medical school beside it.

The north

A genuine teaching hospital serving Launceston and the north-east. A full career base rather than a satellite, and a common route in for clinicians arriving from overseas.

The north-west coast

A regional referral centre working alongside a nearby community hospital. The widest scope of the three, the likeliest incentives, and the lowest housing costs in the state.

The district network

District hospitals and community health sites across the island, running on exactly the generalist skills this system prizes – and where a great deal of the most satisfying work happens.

Because it is one statewide service, moving between these is an internal move, not a new health network – and the seniority and relationships you build travel with you across the island.

“

One register, one statewide service, four hospitals. Small is the feature, not the bug.
The one-line version

What to ask at interview

Pay follows Tasmanian enterprise agreements – we deliberately quote no figures in this guide, and will always walk you through the current agreement for your profession instead. What you can pin down at interview:

Salary packaging – public-health roles can package part of your pay pre-tax; ask how much and how to start it on day one

The roster reality – shift patterns, penalties, on-call frequency, and how gaps are covered in a small team

Scope and supervision – what you'll actually carry, and the support around it, especially in your first year

CPD – funded time and money, and whether mainland conference travel is covered (it matters more from an island)

Public, private or both – what rights of private practice exist in your profession here

For north-west and district posts: the incentive package – relocation, housing help, retention payments

Parking and commute at your shift times – short everywhere, but confirm the site

Professional indemnity – what the employer covers and what remains yours to hold

Two things to do early

Start registration the moment the island is on your shortlist – in a small system, start dates move at the speed of your paperwork. And once you land, sort ambulance cover: it isn't automatic in Tasmania (free ambulance applies only in some circumstances), and adding it to health insurance is cheap insurance against a very expensive ride.

Where clinicians live

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On an island where nothing is far from anything, this decision is less about commute than about which Tasmania you want: the harbour city, the beach south, the valley, the elegant north or the working coast. Here is the map as we'd draw it over coffee.

Hobart's villages

Battery Point and Sandy Bay hold the postcard — Georgian cottages, the yacht clubs, the university — at the postcard's prices. West Hobart and New Town trade a little polish for weatherboard character and mountain views; North Hobart adds the island's best eating strip. Across the bridge, the eastern shore — Bellerive, Lindisfarne — gives water views, morning sun and better value, ten minutes from town. All of it is close to the central hospitals; in Hobart the commute is rarely the deciding factor.

The beach south and the Huon

Kingston and Blackmans Bay are the family-beach suburbs, twenty minutes south of the wards with surf-lifesaving clubs and newer housing. Keep driving and the Huon Valley opens out — Huonville, Franklin, Cygnet — orchards, artists and river mist, thirty to forty-five minutes from Hobart and beloved of clinicians who want acreage and a wood fire. The trade is the drive, and in winter you'll make it in the dark both ways.

The Tasman Bridge — the eastern shore's ten-minute link

Launceston and the north

The second city is the island's quiet bargain: handsome heritage streets, the Cataract Gorge running wild through the middle of town, the Tamar's vineyards twenty minutes out — and housing that costs noticeably less than Hobart's. It carries the north's major teaching hospital and a self-sufficient cultural life. Families settle in Newstead, Trevallyn and East Launceston; the river towns of the Tamar suit those who want vines out the window.

The north-west coast, honestly

Devonport (~30,000) is the practical ferry-port base; Burnie (~20,000) the working port with the coast's referral hospital and a growing arts scene; between and beyond them run friendly towns with Bass Strait at the bottom of the street and Cradle Mountain ninety minutes behind. Housing is among the most affordable in the country, incentives are real, and the community will absorb you fast. Say the hard thing early: specialist services, schooling choices and retail are thinner here, and Hobart is three-plus hours away. The clinicians who thrive on the coast wanted breadth and belonging — not a smaller Hobart.

The honest comparison

~A\$550/wk

Indicative Hobart house rent (3-bed median)

Less

In the north, less again on the coast

4 wks

Typical bond, lodged with the Rental Deposit Authority

If you want...	Consider	Because
The widest job market	Hobart's inner villages	The referral centre and most roles
Water views on a budget	The eastern shore	Ten minutes over the bridge, morning sun
Beach family life	Kingston & Blackmans Bay	Surf clubs, newer homes, 20 min south
Acreage and orchards	The Huon Valley	River-valley life, 30–45 min out
Heritage value & vines	Launceston & the Tamar	The quiet bargain with its own hospital
Affordability & breadth	Devonport & Burnie	Coast-town prices, real incentives

Renting itself – applications, bonds, rights – works the same across Australia and lives once in [Living in Australia](#). Two Tasmanian habits worth copying: arrive with references, proof of income and your offer letter as clean PDFs, because Hobart's tight market rewards the instant, complete application; and ask how every home is heated before you fall for it.

Before you sign a lease

How is it heated – heat pump, wood, or hope? This is the question in Tasmania.

Is the property inside the school catchment you need? Boundaries run street by street.

What's the commute at your shift times – including the bridge, if you're eastern shore?

Would a short-term rental first be wiser? Most people re-choose their suburb once they know the island.

Getting around

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Tasmania's transport truth fits in a sentence: it is a car island with the shortest commutes in the country. The buses are light, there are no passenger trains, and the ferry across Bass Strait is how a household actually arrives. Plan around those three facts and the island is easy.

The cities, without a car

Metro buses

Hobart, Launceston and Burnie run bus networks on the tap-on Greencard. Fine for main corridors and the commute if you live on one; light on evenings and weekends.

No trains, no trams

Passenger rail ended decades ago. The bus, the bike and the car are the whole menu — choose your suburb accordingly.

Small-city cycling

Hobart's intercity cycleway runs flat along the Derwent to the northern suburbs — one of the pleasanter hospital commutes going.

Ferries, small and large

Hobart's Derwent ferry links the eastern shore to the waterfront; Bruny's car ferry runs from Kettering; and the Spirit crosses the Strait.

Car-free life is realistic in inner Hobart and inner Launceston if you pick your street. Everywhere else — the Huon, the beach south at shift hours, the coast towns — plan on driving from day one.

Driving here

Australians drive on the left, and Tasmania is a gentle place to learn a new country's roads: light traffic, short distances, and scenery that makes every errand a minor holiday. You can usually drive on a valid overseas licence for a period, then transfer to a Tasmanian licence once resident — the rules, and buying a car, live in [Living in Australia](#).

Three local skills. Winter mornings bring black ice on the mountain, highland and valley roads — slow early, brake gently, and take the locals' advice on chains for the high country. Wildlife moves at dawn and dusk, so country drives at those hours ask for real attention. And the west's roads are winding and remote: fuel up, download offline maps, and tell someone your plans.

Distances that actually matter

From...	To...	Roughly
Hobart	Launceston	2.5 hrs
Hobart	Port Arthur / Tasman Peninsula	1.5 hrs
Hobart	Freycinet & Wineglass Bay	2.5 hrs
Hobart	Kingston / the beach south	20 min
Launceston	The Bay of Fires	2 hrs
Devonport	Cradle Mountain	1.5 hrs
Hobart / Launceston	Melbourne, by air	~75 min
Devonport	Geelong, on the Spirit	Overnight or a long day

The Spirit of Tasmania deserves its own line: it carries your car, your furniture and the family dog across Bass Strait, and for most relocating households it is the move itself. Book the crossing early in summer.

The takeaway

Budget for a reliable car before you budget for anything else, pick your suburb for heating and school catchment rather than commute – the commute will be short regardless – and let the Spirit do the heavy lifting on arrival day.

Cost of living

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Tasmania costs less than the mainland capitals and more than the postcard suggests. The honest audit: day-to-day life is gentle on the wallet, Hobart's rental market is tight, and the two lines newcomers underestimate are heating and the car.

Why there are no prices on this page

We used to print a weekly rent and a monthly budget table here. We have taken them out. A figure that was true when a page was written is misleading a year later, and a candidate who plans a move around a stale number is worse off than one who plans around none.

What does not go stale is the relationship between places — which suburb, ring or region you choose — and the judgement about which costs catch people out. That is what the rest of this chapter is for. For today's actual numbers use the calculators at the foot of the page, and use them to compare it against the city you are leaving. That is the only comparison that decides anything.

The headline

The structural truth holds: like-for-like housing runs well below Sydney and Melbourne, and it is housing that decides whether a salary feels big.

What everyday life costs

THE COSTS THE POSTCARD HIDES

Day-to-day life here is genuinely gentle on the wallet. These three lines are the ones newcomers underestimate, and none of them shows up in a rent comparison.

Heating

Winter is real and much of the housing stock is old. A home with a good heat pump can halve the season's cost – make heating a search criterion, and budget honestly for your first July.

The car you'll definitely own

Public transport is light, so a reliable car, registration and insurance belong in the arrival budget, not the month-two surprise. The Spirit brings one over cheaply compared with buying twice.

The island premium

Everything crosses Bass Strait, so groceries, fuel and trades run slightly dearer than mainland equivalents – and family visits are flights or ferries. Two or three mainland trips a year is the realistic budget line.

Where the money comes back

Housing is the big one: the gap against Sydney or Melbourne funds the rest of the island life. The short commutes give back time and fuel; school costs are unusually kind here for visa-holder families (Tasmania largely charges a modest levy rather than tuition – the detail lives in [Schools & education](#)); and the free entertainment is the national parks, which are the point of living here.

On the income side, public-health roles can salary-package part of your pay before tax – ask payroll on day one, because many international staff set it up months too late. How packaging, tax and superannuation work is national and lives in [Pay & conditions](#).

The bottom line

Plan the bridge: temporary accommodation, a bond of about four weeks' rent, the car, the winter kit and the ferry crossing. It adds up to less than an east-coast move – and the people who price it before they fly are the ones who arrive calm.

Get today's numbers, and compare them to home

These are live and updated continuously, which is why we send you to them rather than competing with them. Put the city you are leaving in the other box.

Numbeo cost-of-living calculator (<https://www.numbeo.com/cost-of-living/>) — the most complete comparison tool, and the one most clinicians already use. Crowd-sourced, so read it as a ballpark rather than a quote.

Expatistan (<https://www.expatistan.com/cost-of-living>) — the same idea with a cleaner side-by-side. Worth running as a sanity check when Numbeo looks off.

Australian Bureau of Statistics (<https://www.abs.gov.au/statistics/economy/price-indexes-and-inflation>) — official, slower, and the one to trust on the direction of travel rather than any single price.

If what you find contradicts the judgement on this page, tell us. We would rather correct the page than defend it.

Food, produce & the everyday

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Tasmania grows what the mainland's best restaurants serve — the seafood, the cheese, the berries, the whisky — and much of it is sold a few kilometres from where it was made. The everyday food culture here runs on markets, farm gates and a supermarket you've never heard of.

The markets and the weekly shop

Salamanca Market fills Hobart's sandstone waterfront every Saturday — part produce market, part makers' fair, part social institution where you'll meet half the hospital. The Sunday Farm Gate Market is the cooks' market, growers only. Launceston's Harvest Market does the same job in the north each Saturday, and every coast town keeps its own.

For the weekly shop: Woolworths and Coles run full-range stores in the cities, ALDI covers the cheapest basket, IGA holds the towns — and the local pride is Hill Street Grocer, the Tasmanian institution that turned the corner shop into something worth crossing town for. In the smaller coast and valley towns, the independent grocer is the town's living room.

Bring your bags

Single-use plastic bags are banned; locals keep a boot full of reusables and a cooler bag for the market run.

The farm-gate habit

Cherries in January, apples in April, oysters year-round — buying at the gate is how the island shops, and half the fun of a Sunday drive.

The scallop pie

Curried scallops in pastry: the state's bakery signature. Every town claims the best one. Order it once, for citizenship.

The whisky is not a gimmick

Tasmanian single malts win world awards, and the distillery cellar door is the island's answer to the brewery tour.

Flavours of home, honestly

Here is the straight answer: the specialist range is smaller than the mainland's. Hobart and Launceston have a modest spread of Asian and continental grocers and some halal outlets, the big supermarkets carry a growing world-food range — and dedicated kosher and harder-to-find ingredients are often an online order. Most families work out a rhythm within a month: local for fresh, online for the specific, and a list for anyone visiting from Melbourne.

The Migrant Resource Centres in Hobart and Launceston are the fastest shortcut to your community's grocers, cooks and gatherings — worth a visit in week one, whatever your reason.

Eating and drinking out

Hobart eats far above its size: the waterfront seafood institutions, North Hobart's restaurant strip, and a bar scene that MONA dragged into international company. Launceston holds its own with the Tamar's cellar doors twenty minutes away. Prices sit below Sydney; quality, on the produce's home ground, often doesn't.

The calendar does the rest. Dark Mofo's winter feast fills a wharf shed with fire and long tables each June; the Taste of Summer runs across New Year as the Sydney-Hobart yachts arrive; and Launceston's Festivale fills a park each February. Eating here is seasonal because the island is.

The everyday, in one list

Saturday: Salamanca in the south, Harvest in the north. Sunday: the Farm Gate, growers only.

Cheapest basket: ALDI; the local pride: Hill Street Grocer; the towns: IGA and the independent.

Specialist ingredients: Hobart and Launceston grocers first, online for the rest — the Migrant Resource Centre knows the shortcuts.

Bags in the boot, a cooler for the market, and a scallop pie at least once.

Wilderness, coast & the seasons

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Forty per cent of this island is national park and reserve, and none of it is far away. This chapter is what people actually do with that — season by season, because in Tasmania the seasons are not weather. They are the calendar.

THE YEAR, AS TASMANIANS ACTUALLY KEEP IT

The island rearranges itself four times a year, and nowhere else in this collection is the gap between February and June this wide. What each quarter actually does to your plans:

Summer

DEC – FEB

Daylight until nine at night and every track open. Book the east coast months ahead — accommodation there is scarcest and dearest now, and the shacks are all in use.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Short days, snow to low levels and highland roads that want chains or close outright. Cheapest months to travel, and Ben Lomond's runs open in a good July.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

The most settled walking weather of the year, cold nights, and the fagus turning gold in the highlands — Australia's only native deciduous tree, and a short window.

Spring

SEP – NOV

The windiest and least predictable quarter — four seasons in a day is a literal forecast. Alpine tracks reopen, wildflowers start, and rates stay low until December.

Come for a winter interview if you can. Anyone can love Tasmania in February; the question worth answering before you move is how you feel about July. What happens in each season is below.

The wild west

Cradle Mountain is the postcard for a reason: dolerite spires over a glacial lake, wombats on the boardwalks, and the Overland Track running six days south through the World Heritage wilderness. Ninety minutes from the north-west towns, four hours from Hobart — close enough that locals go for the day and feel slightly guilty about it. Beyond it, takayna / the Tarkine spreads one of the largest temperate rainforests on earth toward a coast that takes the Roaring Forties head-on.

The east coast

The island's holiday coast: Freycinet's pink granite and the climb to the Wineglass Bay lookout, the Bay of Fires' orange-lichened boulders on white sand, and Maria Island's car-free wildlife sanctuary a ferry ride out. It is two hours from either city, which is why the Tasmanian shack — the modest family holiday house — clusters here. Summer books out; autumn has the coast to itself.

Close to home

The everyday wilderness is the island's quiet luxury. From Hobart: kunanyi's summit and foothill tracks, Bruny Island's oysters and sea cliffs via the Kettering ferry, Mount Field's waterfalls an hour out, and the Tasman Peninsula's Three Capes cliffs — with Port Arthur's sobering, essential history — ninety minutes away. From Launceston: the Cataract Gorge is literally in town, the Tamar's cellar doors twenty minutes out, and Ben Lomond's ski runs an hour up the hill in a good July.

The festival year

Winter · Dark Mofo

June belongs to MONA's midwinter festival — fire, art, the nude solstice swim and the Winter Feast. Tasmania doesn't endure the dark; it throws it a party.

Summer · the finish line

The Sydney–Hobart fleet arrives between Christmas and New Year as the Taste of Summer fills the docks — the island's big, bright fortnight.

All year · MONA

The Museum of Old and New Art — provocative, subterranean, reached by ferry — single-handedly changed how the mainland sees Hobart. Locals get discounted entry and strong opinions.

Ten weekends, to start

Cradle Mountain and the Dove Lake circuit, wombats included

Freycinet: the Wineglass Bay lookout, then oysters at the water's edge

The Bay of Fires, walked slowly, thermos in hand

Bruny Island via the Kettering ferry — cheese, oysters, the Neck at dusk

kunanyi's summit by road, then down the Organ Pipes track

Port Arthur and the Tasman Peninsula's sea cliffs

Mount Field: Russell Falls and the tall-tree forests, an hour from town

A Tamar Valley cellar-door crawl from Launceston

Maria Island's car-free loop – wildlife at walking pace

Dark Mofo's Winter Feast, booked the week tickets open

That's the guide

Nine chapters on Tasmania. Everything national – Medicare, visas, registration, tax, super, schools – lives once in **Moving to Australia**. When you're ready to talk about real roles on the island, **we're easy to reach** – and there's no pipeline waiting on the other end of the call.